

D758

Considerations for Instructional Planning for Learners

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A fourth grader gets a research-based reading intervention in a group of 6 for 20 minutes, 3 days a week. After 8 weeks, his progress is well below his aimline, and the intervention has been delivered as designed. His teacher recently returned from maternity leave. What is the best next step?

- A. Intensify by reducing the group to 2-3 and increasing sessions to 5 days a week, then keep monitoring.
- B. Keep everything the same for another 8 weeks.
- C. Wait until the teacher settles back in.
- D. Switch to a new program and a new teacher and double the time at once.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A student's mastery criterion for subtraction with regrouping is 90% accuracy across 3 sessions in a row. Her scores are 92%, 75%, 94%. The unit calendar says to move on tomorrow, and she likes working at the standing desk. What should the teacher do?

- A. Move on, since her average is 87%.
- B. Move her to the standing desk for more practice.
- C. Move on, since the calendar says so.
- D. Continue practice until she has 3 sessions in a row at 90% or higher.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A criterion reads: '80% accuracy on 4 of 5 sessions.' A student scored 85%, 70%, 82%, 90%, 81%. Has she met it?

- A. Yes, because her average is over 80%.
- B. Yes; 4 of 5 sessions are at or above 80%.
- C. No; she needs 5 of 5.
- D. No; one session was below 80%.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A student answers multiplication facts with 98% accuracy but completes only 12 per minute; the goal is 40. He enjoys drawing comics and sits near the window. Which instruction fits?

- A. Let him draw comics about multiplication.
- B. Move straight to word problems in new settings.
- C. Brief timed practice with goal setting and graphing.
- D. Reteach the facts with modeling and demonstration.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student reads sight words quickly but gets 55% of them wrong. What stage is he in, and what does he need?

- A. Generalization; practice in new books.
- B. Acquisition; modeling, guided practice, and immediate corrective feedback.
- C. Mastery; move on.
- D. Fluency; more timed drills.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A student with an intellectual disability learned to count coins using the same plastic coins at the same table with his teacher. At the school store, he cannot count real coins. The store is open Wednesdays and sells pencils. What should the teacher do?

- A. Conclude that he cannot learn money skills.
- B. Let him buy a pencil without counting.
- C. Practice more with the same plastic coins.
- D. Teach with real coins, varied amounts, different people, and settings including the store.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A sixth grader with ADHD often stops working during independent math. The teacher wants to build independence. The student's favorite color is green, and the class uses a new math app. Which plan uses self-monitoring?

- A. Give him a green checklist without teaching how to use it.
- B. Teach him to mark 'yes' or 'no' to 'Am I working?' when a quiet vibrating timer goes off, and review the sheet together.
- C. Assign more problems in the math app.
- D. The teacher marks his on-task behavior every 5 minutes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's self-monitoring records match the teacher's only 70% of the time, but his on-task behavior has risen sharply. What should the teacher conclude?

- A. Use only the student's records for grading.
- B. Switch to teacher-only monitoring.
- C. Keep using it, since behavior improved, and add periodic accuracy checks.
- D. Stop it, since the records are not accurate.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A teacher wants students with learning disabilities to plan persuasive essays using the POW + TREE strategy. The class has 11 students and a new smartboard. What is the best way to teach it?

- A. Show a video of the strategy on the smartboard.
- B. Post a POW + TREE poster and assign an essay.
- C. Discuss and model it with think-alouds and self-talk, have students memorize it, then support practice and fade to independence with goal setting.
- D. Have students write essays until they discover a strategy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A student read 42 words correct per minute in week 1 and 60 in week 10 (9 weeks of growth). The goal requires 2.5 words per week. The student likes reading about sharks. What is the rate of improvement, and is it enough?

- A. 2.0 words per week; below the needed 2.5.
- B. 18 words per week; well above the goal.
- C. 2.0 words per week; above the goal.
- D. 1.8 words per week; below the goal.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student reads 50 words correct per minute now. The goal is 90 in 20 weeks. What weekly rate of improvement is needed?

- A. 4.5 words per week
- B. 0.5 words per week
- C. 40 words per week
- D. 2.0 words per week

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12.

A third grader with a disability has had a paraprofessional beside him all day for two years. He now waits for her before starting any task and rarely talks to peers. The paraprofessional is patient and has worked at the school for 15 years. What should the teacher plan?

- A. Have the paraprofessional use least-intrusive prompts from a distance, support the whole group, and fade over time while data are collected.
- B. Remove the paraprofessional immediately.
- C. Keep the same arrangement, since it is working for her.
- D. Add a second paraprofessional.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A fourth grader gets a research-based reading intervention in a group of 6 for 20 minutes, 3 days a week. After 8 weeks, his progress is well below his aimline, and the intervention has been delivered as designed. ~~His teacher recently returned from maternity leave.~~ What is the best next step?

Target word: how to intensify **Decides:** Fidelity is good but growth is low.

A	Correct	Changes dosage and group size, keeping a good program.
B	Dropped element	Drops the data-based decision.
C	Camouflage	Irrelevant.
D	Absolute language	Changing everything prevents knowing what helped.

2. Answer D Concept 2

A student's mastery criterion for subtraction with regrouping is 90% accuracy across 3 sessions in a row. Her scores are 92%, 75%, 94%. The unit calendar says to move on tomorrow, ~~and she likes working at the standing desk.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: mastery decision **Decides:** Criterion not met across 3 in a row.

A	Confusion set	The criterion is consecutive sessions, not average.
B	Camouflage	Irrelevant.
C	Inverted operation	Calendar over data.
D	Correct	The criterion is not yet met.

3. Answer B Concept 2 · transfer

A criterion reads: '80% accuracy on 4 of 5 sessions.' A student scored 85%, 70%, 82%, 90%, 81%. Has she met it?

Target word: apply criterion **Decides:** Count sessions at or above 80%.

A	Confusion set	Right result, wrong rule.
B	Correct	Only 70% is below.
C	Wrong stem number	Misreads 4 of 5.
D	Absolute language	The criterion allows one miss.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A student answers multiplication facts with 98% accuracy but completes only 12 per minute; the goal is 40. ~~He enjoys drawing comics and sits near the window.~~ Which instruction fits?

Target word: match stage to instruction **Decides:** Accurate but slow: fluency stage.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant.
B	Adjacent category	Generalization before fluency.
C	Correct	Fluency-building fits accurate but slow work.
D	Inverted operation	Acquisition instruction for a student who is already accurate.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A student reads sight words quickly but gets 55% of them wrong. What stage is he in, and what does he need?

Target word: reverse: from data to stage **Decides:** Low accuracy: acquisition.

A	Adjacent category	Too early.
B	Correct	Accuracy must come first.
C	Dropped element	Drops the accuracy data.
D	Inverted operation	Speed practice builds errors.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A student with an intellectual disability learned to count coins using the same plastic coins at the same table with his teacher. At the school store, he cannot count real coins. ~~The store is open Wednesdays and sells pencils.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: promote transfer **Decides:** Skill taught with only one set of materials and one setting.

A	Absolute language	Transfer needs to be taught.
B	Camouflage	Skips the skill.
C	Inverted operation	Repeats the narrow training.
D	Correct	Multiple exemplars build transfer.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A sixth grader with ADHD often stops working during independent math. The teacher wants to build independence. ~~The student's favorite color is green, and the class uses a new math app.~~ Which plan uses self-monitoring?

Target word: self-monitoring plan **Decides:** Student records own behavior against a target.

A	Camouflage	Uses the color; drops the teaching.
B	Correct	Taught self-recording builds independence.
C	Dropped element	Drops the self-monitoring.
D	Inverted operation	Teacher monitoring, not self-monitoring.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A student's self-monitoring records match the teacher's only 70% of the time, but his on-task behavior has risen sharply. What should the teacher conclude?

Target word: reverse: accuracy vs. effect **Decides:** Self-monitoring can work even when imperfectly accurate.

A	Adjacent category	Self-monitoring is a tool, not a grade source.
B	Inverted operation	Removes the independence goal.
C	Correct	Reactivity improves behavior; accuracy can be built over time.
D	Absolute language	Perfect accuracy is not required for benefit.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A teacher wants students with learning disabilities to plan persuasive essays using the POW + TREE strategy. ~~The class has 11 students and a new smartboard.~~ What is the best way to teach it?

Target word: SRSD delivery **Decides:** Explicit strategy plus self-regulation, in stages.

A	Camouflage	Tool detail; no staged instruction.
B	Dropped element	Drops modeling and guided practice.
C	Correct	Follows SRSD stages and adds self-regulation.
D	Inverted operation	Discovery instead of explicit teaching.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A student read 42 words correct per minute in week 1 and 60 in week 10 (9 weeks of growth). The goal requires 2.5 words per week. ~~The student likes reading about sharks.~~ What is the rate of improvement, and is it enough?

Target word: compute ROI **Decides:** $(60 - 42) / 9$.

A	Correct	$18 / 9 = 2.0$, below 2.5.
B	Dropped element	Drops the division by weeks.
C	Inverted operation	Right number, wrong comparison.
D	Wrong stem number	Divides by 10 weeks instead of 9 weeks of growth.

11. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

A student reads 50 words correct per minute now. The goal is 90 in 20 weeks. What weekly rate of improvement is needed?

Target word: solve for needed rate **Decides:** $(90 - 50) / 20$.

A	Dropped element	$90 / 20$ drops the starting score.
B	Inverted operation	$20 / 40$ flips the division.
C	Dropped element	Drops the weeks.
D	Correct	$40 / 20 = 2.0$.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A third grader with a disability has had a paraprofessional beside him all day for two years. He now waits for her before starting any task and rarely talks to peers. ~~The paraprofessional is patient and has worked at the school for 15 years.~~ What should the teacher plan?

Target word: fade para support **Decides:** Dependence and reduced peer interaction.

A	Correct	Planned fading builds independence and peer contact.
B	Absolute language	Abrupt removal without a plan.
C	Camouflage	Uses her experience; ignores the student's dependence.
D	Inverted operation	Increases dependence.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	3	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Intensifying an intervention	When a student does not respond, intensify by changing dosage (time, frequency), group size, explicitness, or feedback, one or two variables at a time.	Switching to a different program before adjusting how the current one is delivered, or changing everything at once.	Progress data show too little growth in a well-run intervention.
2	Teaching to a mastery criterion	Set a clear criterion (for example, 90% accuracy across 3 sessions) and move on only when it is met, so later skills rest on solid foundations.	Moving on because the calendar says so or after one good day.	A decision about when to advance to the next skill.
3	Instructional hierarchy	Learning moves from acquisition (accuracy) to fluency (speed), then generalization and adaptation; match the teaching to the stage.	Using timed drills before the student is accurate, or modeling again when the student is accurate but slow.	Accuracy and speed data for the same skill.
4	Multiple exemplar training	Teach a skill with many varied examples, settings, materials, and people so it transfers beyond the teaching situation.	Teaching with one worksheet or one example and expecting transfer.	A student performs the skill only in the setting where it was taught.
5	Self-monitoring	Teach students to observe and record their own behavior or performance against a target, which builds independence and often improves the behavior.	Thinking self-monitoring only works if the student's records are perfectly accurate, or giving the form without teaching it.	A goal to make a student less dependent on adult prompts.
6	Self-regulated strategy development (SRSD)	SRSD explicitly teaches a strategy plus self-regulation (goal setting, self-talk, self-monitoring) through stages: develop background, discuss, model, memorize, support, independent use.	Handing students a mnemonic poster without modeling and guided practice.	Teaching a writing or problem-solving strategy to students with learning disabilities.
7	Rate of improvement	Rate of improvement = (later score – earlier score) ÷ number of weeks; compare it to the rate needed to reach the goal.	Dividing by the number of data points or ignoring the needed rate.	Two scores and a number of weeks.
8	Fading paraprofessional support	Plan for paraprofessionals to prompt from a distance and fade support over time so students build independence and peer interaction.	Assigning a paraprofessional to sit next to a student all day indefinitely.	A student who waits for the aide before starting any task.

Course scope (public description): Considerations for Instructional Planning for Learners is designed to introduce special education teachers to a repertoire of evidence-based instructional strategies to advance the learning of students with exceptionalities. The course focuses specifically on strategies for intensifying and individualizing instructional interventions; making instructional decisions based on progress- monitoring data; collaborating with general education teachers and paraprofessionals; teaching to mastery; promoting

generalization of learning; and teaching students with exceptionalities how to use self-assessment, problem solving, and other cognitive strategies to organize critical content and meet their needs.